

BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE OVERVIEW REPORT

INTRODUCTION TO BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE

Business Intelligence (BI) is the process of using data, analytical techniques, and technology to transform business data into meaningful information that supports informed decision-making. Business Intelligence enables organisations to monitor performance, identify trends, understand business performance, and use evidence to guide business decisions.

In this task, Business Intelligence is applied to the Sample - Superstore dataset, which contains transactional information covering orders, customers, products, regions, sales, discounts, quantities, and profit. The dataset contains 9,994 records and 21 fields (columns), providing a suitable basis for analysing different aspects of retail business performance.

IMPORTANCE OF BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE

Business Intelligence is used by organisations to gain better visibility into their operations and performance. Business Intelligence helps decision-makers understand what is happening within the business, identify areas requiring attention, and discover opportunities for improvement.

For a retail organisation, Business Intelligence can help management monitor sales and profitability, compare regional performance, understand customer segments, evaluate product performance, and identify changes in performance over time.

IMPORTANCE OF DASHBOARDS IN DECISION MAKING

Dashboards provide a visual and consolidated way of presenting important business information. An interactive dashboard allows users to monitor key performance indicators, compare different business areas, identify trends, and filter information according to their needs.

For this project, a Power BI dashboard will provide management with a centralized view of sales, profitability, customer segments, product categories, and regional performance. This will make it easier to identify high-performing and underperforming areas and focus attention on areas that may require further investigation.

BUSINESS PROBLEM

The retail company has a large volume of transactional data containing information about customers, products, locations, sales, discounts, quantities, and profit. However, raw transactional data alone does not provide management with an immediate and consolidated view of business performance.

Therefore the management requires an interactive Business Intelligence dashboard that can bring together key performance information and help identify sales and profitability patterns across regions, customer segments, and products.

BUSINESS OBJECTIVE

The objective of this task is to develop an interactive Power BI dashboard that analyses the Superstore dataset to help management monitor sales and profitability, evaluate customer and regional performance, identify product performance and trends over time, and generate actionable insights that can support better business decisions.

KEY BUSINESS QUESTIONS

The analysis will focus on answering the following business questions:

1. What is the overall sales performance?
2. Which regions generate the highest sales and profit?
3. Which customer segments contribute the most revenue?
4. Which product categories perform best?
5. Which products are most profitable?
6. What trends can be observed over time?
7. What should management do to improve business performance?

These questions will guide the analysis and determine the key visualizations and metrics required in the Power BI dashboard.